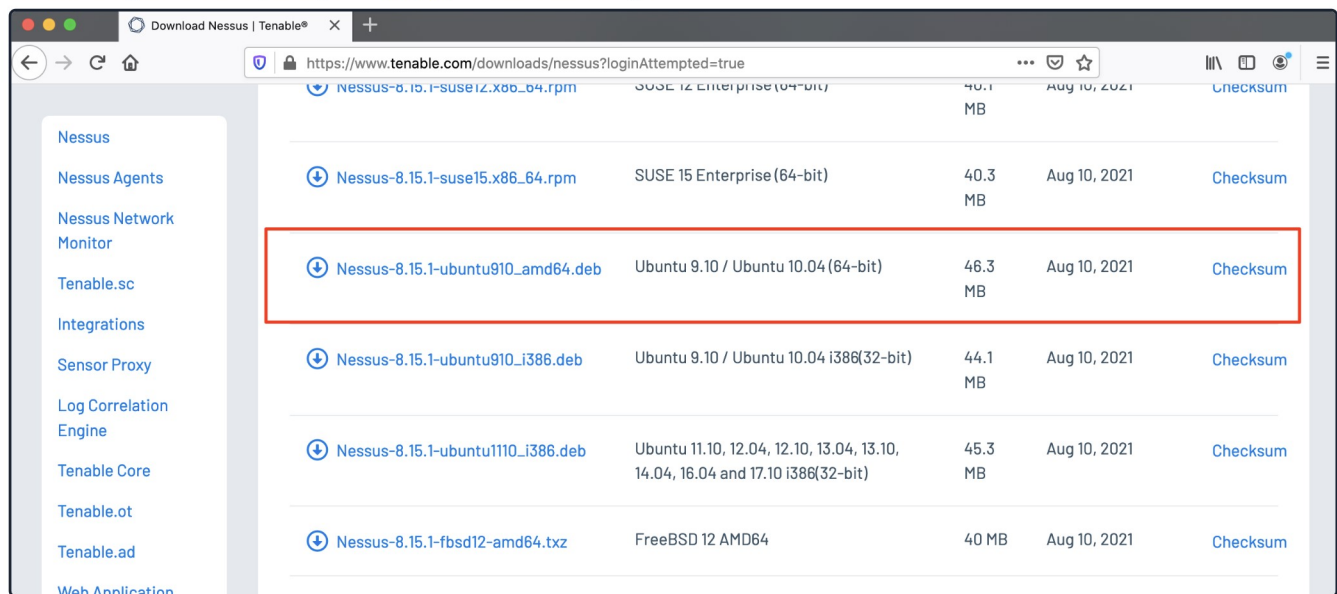


Getting Started with Nessus

Let's see how we can download and set up Nessus for its first use so that we can start learning its various features. Feel free to follow along and set up a Nessus instance on your own VM. For the interactive portions of this module, we provide a lab instance of Nessus and another with OpenVAS installed.

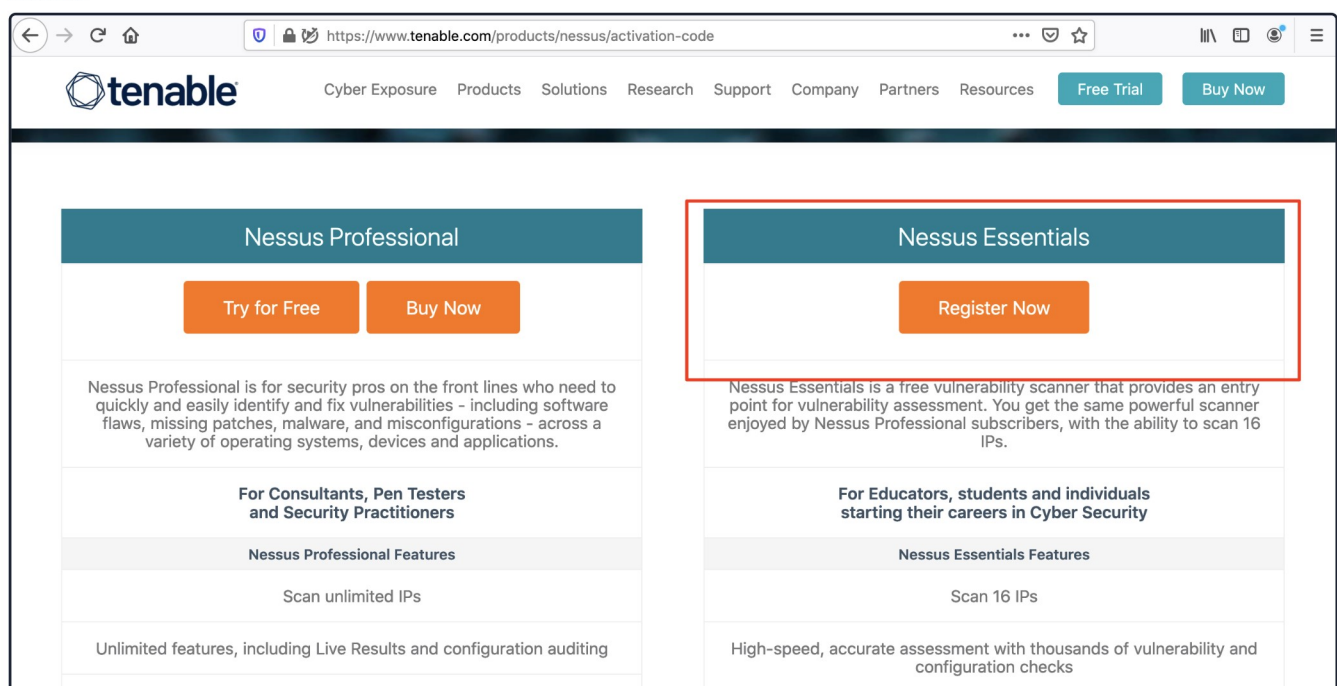
Downloading Nessus

To download Nessus, we can navigate to its [Download Page](#) to download the correct Nessus binary for our system. We will be downloading the Debian package for **Ubuntu** for this walkthrough.



Requesting Free License

Next, we can visit the [Activation Code Page](#) to request a Nessus Activation Code, which is necessary to get the free version of Nessus:



Accurate, high-speed asset discovery and broad coverage and profiling

World's largest continuously-updated library of vulnerability and configuration checks

Agentless scanning of your network

Support via the Tenable Community

[Downloads](#) / Nessus

Nessus

Need an Activation Code?

In order to complete your Nessus installation, you need an activation code if you don't have one already.

[Get Activation Code](#)

Installing Package

With both the binary and activation code in hand, we can now install the Nessus package:

```
dbcypth0n@htb[/htb]$ dpkg -i Nessus-8.15.1-ubuntu910_amd64.deb
```

```
Selecting previously unselected package nessus.
```

```
(Reading database ... 132030 files and directories currently installed.)
```

```
Preparing to unpack Nessus-8.15.1-ubuntu910_amd64.deb ...
```

```
Unpacking nessus (8.15.1) ...
```

```
Setting up nessus (8.15.1) ...
```

```
Unpacking Nessus Scanner Core Components...
```

```
Created symlink /etc/systemd/system/nessusd.service → /lib/systemd/system/nessusd.service.
```

```
Created symlink /etc/systemd/system/multi-user.target.wants/nessusd.service → /lib/systemd/system/nessusd.service.
```

Starting Nessus

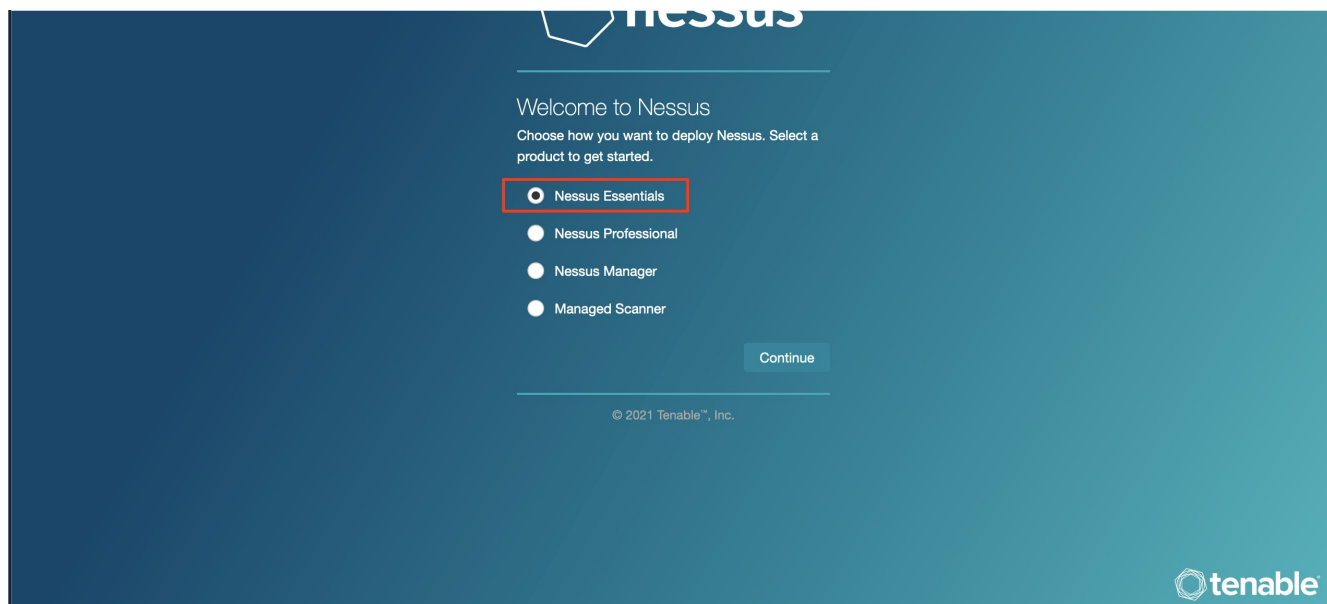
Once we have Nessus installed, we can start the Nessus Service:

```
dbcypth0n@htb[/htb]$ sudo systemctl start nessusd.service
```

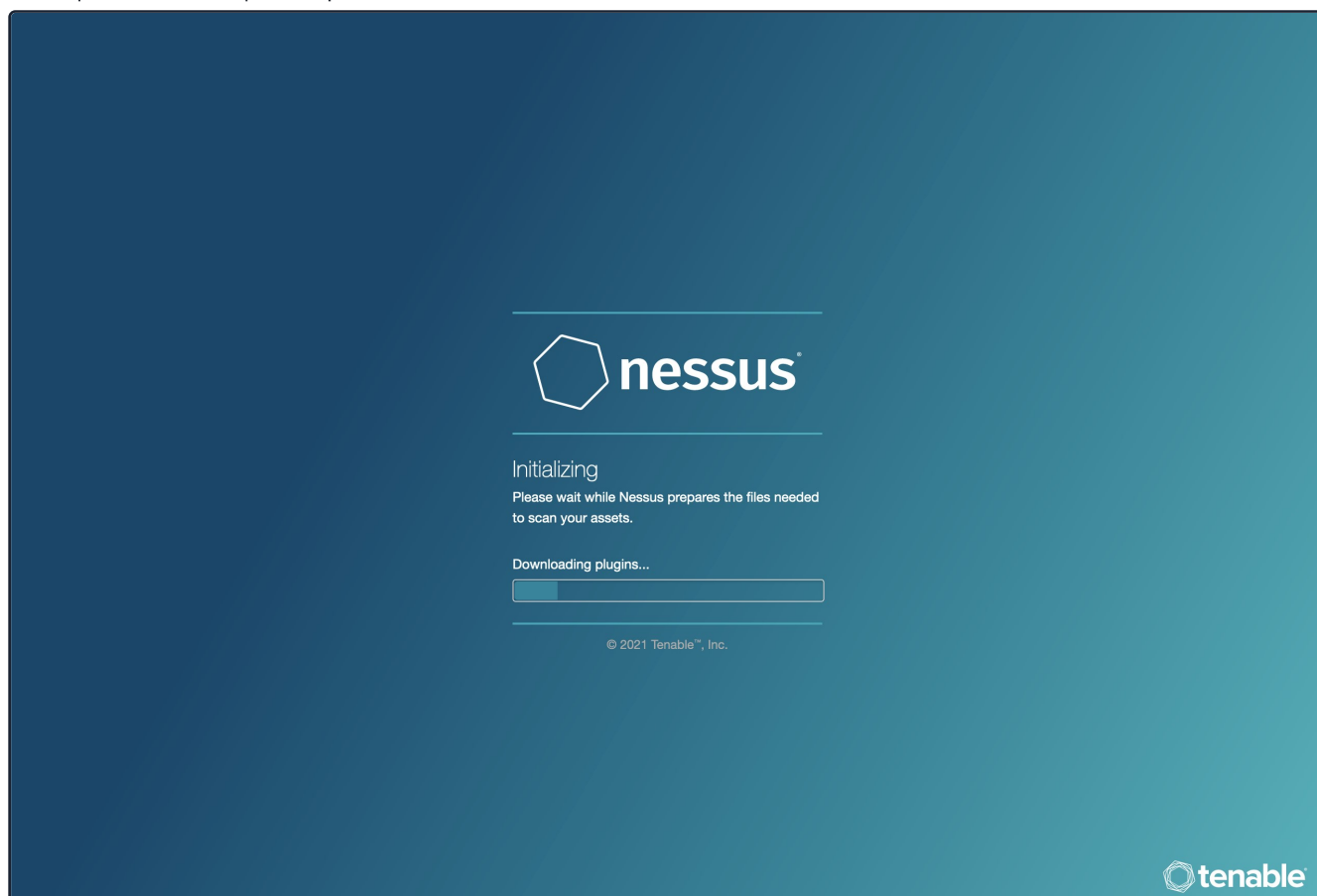
Accessing Nessus

To access Nessus, we can navigate to <https://localhost:8834>. Once we arrive at the setup page, we should select **Nessus Essentials** for the free version, and then we can enter our activation code:





Once we enter our activation code, we can set up a user with a **secure** password for our Nessus account. Then, the plugins will begin to compile once this step is completed:



Note: The VM provided at the **Nessus Skills Assessment** section has Nessus pre-installed and the targets running. You can go to that section and start the VM and use Nessus throughout the module, which can be accessed at [https:// < IP >:8834](https://<IP>:8834). The Nessus credentials are: **htb-student:HTB_@cademy_student!**. You may also use these credentials to SSH into the target VM to configure Nessus.

Finally, once the setup is complete, we can start creating scans, scan policies, plugin rules, and customizing settings. The **Settings** page has a wealth of options such as setting up a Proxy Server or SMTP server, standard account management options, and advanced settings to customize the user interface, scanning, logging, performance, and security options.



ABOUT

Advanced

Proxy Server

Remote Link

SMTP Server

Custom CA

Upgrade Assistant

Password Mgmt

Scanner Health

Notifications

ACCOUNTS

My Account

Advanced Settings allow you to manually configure global settings. In order for these settings to take effect, a restart of the Nessus service or server may be required. NOTICE: Settings configured in scans or policies will override these values.

User Interface

Scanning

Logging

Performance

Security

Miscellaneous

81 Settings

Setting	Identifier	Value
Allow Post-Scan Editing	allow_post_scan_editing	Yes
Disable API	disable_api	No
Disable Frontend	disable_frontend	No
Login Banner	login_banner	
Maximum Concurrent Web Users	global_max_web_users	1024
Nessus Web Server IP	listen_address	0.0.0.0
Nessus Web Server Port	xmlrpc_listen_port	8834

[< Previous](#)
[Next >](#)
[✔ Mark Complete & Next](#)

Table of Contents

Security Assessments

[Security Assessments](#)

[Vulnerability Assessment](#)

[Assessment Standards](#)


Vulnerability Scoring and Reporting

[Common Vulnerability Scoring System \(CVSS\)](#)

[Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures \(CVE\)](#)


Nessus

[Vulnerability Scanning Overview](#)

[Getting Started with Nessus](#)
[Nessus Scan](#)
[Advanced Settings](#)
[Working with Nessus Scan Output](#)
[Scanning Issues](#)
[Nessus Skills Assessment](#)

OpenVAS

[Getting Started with OpenVAS](#)
[OpenVAS Scan](#)
[Exporting The Results](#)
[OpenVAS Skills Assessment](#)

Reporting

[Reporting](#)

My Workstation

O F F L I N E

 Start Instance

 / 1 spawns left